

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Three structurally different major-power ties

CHINA -> interdependence plus mistrust; largest trade partner in the book-period assessment; unresolved boundary dispute drives the strategic reading

UNITED STATES -> technology-led tactical convergence; enabling agreements and frameworks; high-technology export restrictions persist

RUSSIA -> defence-energy complementarity; energy-deficient meets energy-surplus; high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere

RULE -> a three-track hedge, never a binary China-versus-West alignment

MUST REMEMBER: India's relations with China and other major powers combine border...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Policy-term discipline

DE-RISKING -> reduce overconcentration while sustaining engagement; India's posture

DECOUPLING -> sever engagement altogether; expressly not India's posture

FRIEND-SHORING -> divert critical supply chains toward trusted partners, not cost alone

REPLACEMENT -> the incorrect reading; the correct one is diversification of dependence

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: India-United States technology timeline

MAY 2022 -> initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced
31 JANUARY 2023 -> inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting
17 JUNE 2024 -> second National Security Adviser-level review
21 SEPTEMBER 2024 -> clean-energy supply-chain commitments announced
13 FEBRUARY 2025 -> TRUST and COMPACT announced with Mission 500 and trade talks
STATUS -> cooperation initiatives and branding; no documented legal succession

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Defence architecture ladder

2016 -> India designated a Major Defence Partner by the United States

LEMOA 2016 -> reciprocal logistics support

COMCASA 2018 -> secure communications

BECA 2020 -> exchange of geospatial information

31 OCTOBER 2025 -> ten-year Framework for the US-India Major Defense Partnership

LIMIT -> enabling agreements and a framework; no collective defence, no basing right

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Russia track evidence card

COMPLEMENTARITY -> India energy-deficient, Russia energy-surplus

UNIQUE SUPPLY -> high-technology equipment including nuclear-powered submarines

INSTALLED BASE -> Su-30MKI licensed production; BrahMos joint venture

2018 -> S-400 contract as the named high-end acquisition

AK-203 -> Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa; localisation to be verified

UNVERIFIED -> S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: India-China process architecture

21 OCTOBER 2024 -> patrolling arrangements announced; specified as Depsang and Demchok
-> 18 DECEMBER 2024: twenty-third Special Representatives round, Beijing
-> 19 AUGUST 2025: twenty-fourth round, New Delhi; Expert Group on early harvest delimitation; WMCC working group; General-Level Mechanisms in Eastern and Middle sectors
-> 31 AUGUST 2025: leaders meet at Tianjin
-> 27 MAY 2026: thirty-fifth WMCC, Beijing, prepares the next round
STATUS -> process architecture, expressly not a boundary settlement
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Border claim, Line of Actual Control perception, agreed boundary,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Designated border-trade points

LIPULEKH -> existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

SHIPKI LA -> existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

NATHU LA -> existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

SOURCE -> agreed at the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round, 19 August 2025

LIMIT -> provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Tariff cycle stress test

7 AUGUST 2025 -> 25 per cent India-specific reciprocal duty, Executive Order 14326
27 AUGUST 2025 -> additional 25 per cent Russian-oil-linked duty, Executive Order 14329
4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 -> India calls the action unjustified and unreasonable
7 FEBRUARY 2026 -> additional duty removed, Executive Order 14384
FEBRUARY 2026 -> IEEPA additional duties ended by Executive Order 14389
24 JULY 2026 -> separate 10 per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods
READING -> partnership and coercive trade measures ran from the same partner at once

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Japan diversification pillar

2014 -> elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership

20 AUGUST 2024 -> third two-plus-two agrees to revise the 2008 security declaration

SEPTEMBER 2020 -> Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed; operational 2021

SINCE 2017 -> JICA commitments exceeding one trillion yen for high-speed rail

APRIL 2021 -> Supply Chain Resilience Initiative with Australia and Japan

LIMIT -> logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: European Union pillar and legal status

CHANNEL -> Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards

27 JANUARY 2026 -> free trade agreement negotiations concluded

PENDING -> legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force

CONSEQUENCE -> a concluded negotiation is neither signature nor entry into force

GAIN -> wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Ukraine engine and minilateral balancing

PRINCIPLES -> dialogue and diplomacy; sovereignty and territorial integrity invoked

-> UN POSTURE: generally abstained on polarising resolutions; humanitarian assistance sent

-> ENERGY AND FERTILISER: discounted supplies redirected toward India

-> EXPOSURE: sanctions risk, payment and logistics friction, unilateral tariff pressure

-> MINILATERAL: non-treaty Quad and I2U2 add channels at a coordination cost

SPIILLOVER -> Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a major-power demand

OPEN -> state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties

BUILD -> evidence each track with one dated instrument at its exact evidentiary level

TEST -> price the tariff cycle and the technology-access friction as real, dated limits

CLOSE -> refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Distinguish announced initiative,...